Skippy for Mac and iPhone User Guide

Install and use Skippy on a Mac and on an iPhone - version 1.18.0

Skippy is group video calling for up to 10 people: audio, video, chat, file transfer and direct calls. This guide covers the **Mac app** and the **iPhone app**. Both connect to a Skippy server run by someone in your group, so you need that server's address and an account on it.

> **These are test releases.** The Mac and iPhone apps were built and checked for errors, but the author does not own Apple devices and has not been able to run them. You are among the first people to try them. If something doesn't work, please report it - see **Reporting a problem** at the end. Thank you!

Part 1 - The Mac app

What you need

- A Mac running **macOS 12 (Monterey) or newer** (a recent version is best), Apple silicon or Intel. One file works on both.
- The **server address** from whoever runs your Skippy server, for example **100.64.0.10:8470**.
- If that address starts with **100.** it is a Tailscale address: install **Tailscale** on the Mac, sign in to the same account as the server and switch it on.
- The file **Skippy-1.18.0-mac.dmg** from the **apple-v1.18.0** release at github.com/lrizio/Skippy/releases (about 220 MB).

Install

1. Download **Skippy-1.18.0-mac.dmg** and double-click it in your Downloads folder.
2. Drag the **Skippy** icon onto the **Applications** folder in the window that opens. Eject the disk image.
3. Open **Applications**, **right-click** (or Control-click) **Skippy** and choose **Open**. A warning appears; click **Open** again. You only do this the first time.

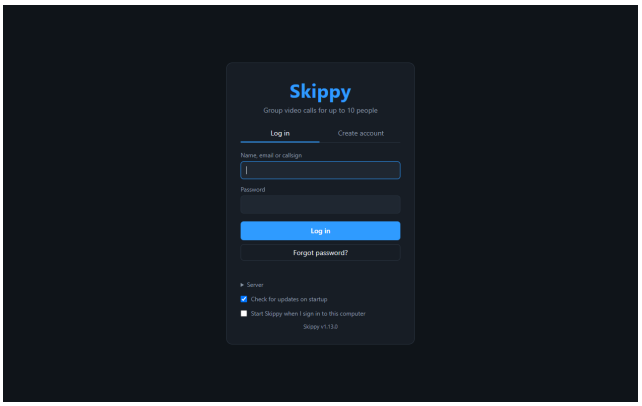
> **"Skippy can't be opened because Apple cannot check it for malicious software."** The app is not signed with an Apple developer certificate (that costs the author US$99 a year), so macOS is cautious. If right-click Open does not offer an Open button: open **System Settings, Privacy & Security**, scroll down to the message about Skippy and click **Open Anyway**. Or, in Terminal, run:

```
xattr -dr com.apple.quarantine /Applications/Skippy.app
```

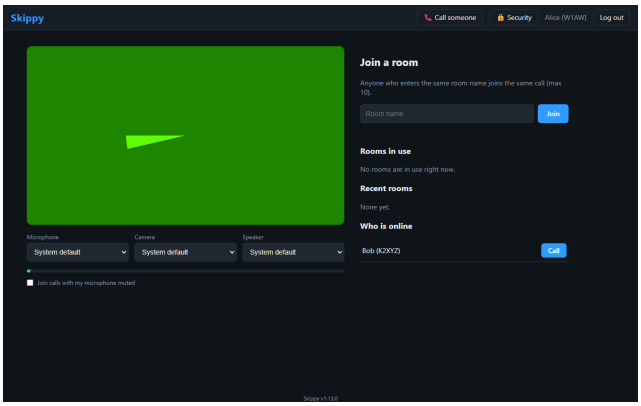
Only do this with the file from the official release page.

First start

1. macOS asks to let Skippy use the **microphone** and then the **camera**. Click **OK** to both. (If you said no: **System Settings, Privacy & Security, Camera / Microphone**, switch Skippy on, then quit and reopen Skippy.)
2. On the login screen open **Server** and type the server address (the **ws://** at the front is optional).
3. New here? Click **Create account**. Otherwise log in with your name, email or callsign. Save the **recovery key** Skippy shows you - it is the only way back in if you forget your password.



Login screen (shown on Windows; the Mac looks the same inside the window).



The lobby: preview, devices, rooms and who is online.

Using the Mac app

Everything works as in the Windows desktop app: rooms, direct calls, chat, file transfer, two-step codes, and the people list. Differences on the Mac:

Topic	On the Mac
Menu bar icon	Skippy puts an icon in the **menu bar** (top right). Click it for **Open Skippy**, **Start when I sign in to this computer** and **Quit Skippy**.
Closing the window	The red close button **hides** the window; Skippy keeps running so calls can still come in, and the Dock icon disappears. Click the menu bar icon to bring it back. To really quit: **Cmd+Q** or menu bar icon, **Quit Skippy**.
Start at login	Tick **Start when I sign in to this computer** in the menu bar menu. Skippy then starts hidden.
Screen sharing	Click **Share** and pick a screen or window. The first time, macOS asks for **Screen Recording** permission: **System Settings, Privacy & Security, Screen & System Audio Recording**, switch Skippy on, then quit and reopen Skippy.
Tailscale warning	If the server is on Tailscale and it is switched off, Skippy shows a banner with a button to turn it on.
Updates	Skippy tells you when a newer release exists; download the new .dmg and drag it over the old app.

Recording and transcripts on the Mac

Record saves one audio track per speaker to **Documents/Skippy Recordings**. To turn recordings into a text transcript the Mac needs a free speech engine. In Terminal (with Homebrew installed) run:

```
brew install whisper-cpp
```

Then in Skippy open **Recordings** and choose the transcript setup: it downloads the language model (about 190 MB) once. After that transcripts are made on your Mac, offline.

Part 2 - The iPhone app

The iPhone app is a **client only**, like the Android one: log in, join rooms, call one person, chat and send files. Not on the phone: screen sharing, recording/transcripts, and **ringing while the app is closed** - people can call you only while Skippy is open.

What you need

- An iPhone (or iPad) running **iOS 15 or newer**.
- The **server address** (see above) and, for a 100.x address, the **Tailscale** app switched on.
- The file **Skippy-unsigned.ipa** from the **apple-v1.18.0** release, and a way to sign it (below).

Why installing is more work than on Android. Apple only lets apps onto an iPhone if they are signed. Skippy is not on the App Store, so you sign it yourself with your own (free) Apple ID, using one of the tools below. A free Apple ID's apps stop opening after **7 days** and must be signed again (the tools can do this automatically while the phone and computer are on the same Wi-Fi). A paid Apple Developer account (US$99 a year) lasts a year.

Install - choose one method

Method A: Sideloadly (Mac or Windows PC, simplest)

1. Install **Sideloadly** (sideloadly.io) on your computer. On Windows it also needs iTunes and iCloud from apple.com (not the Microsoft Store versions) - Sideloadly tells you.
2. Connect the iPhone with a cable and tap **Trust This Computer**.
3. Drag **Skippy-unsigned.ipa** into Sideloadly, type your **Apple ID**, and click **Start**. Enter your Apple ID password when asked (it goes to Apple, not to Sideloadly's author or to Skippy).
4. On the iPhone open **Settings, Privacy & Security**, scroll down, switch on **Developer Mode** and restart when asked (iOS 16 and newer).
5. Open **Settings, General, VPN & Device Management**, tap your Apple ID under *Developer App* and tap **Trust**.
6. Open **Skippy** from the Home Screen.

Method B: AltStore

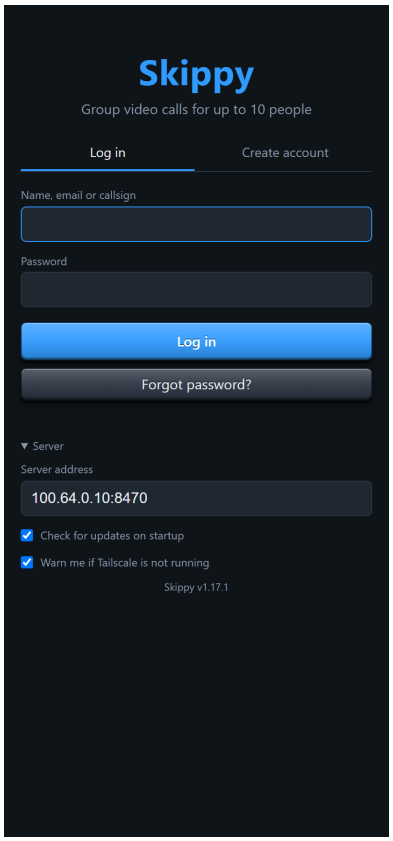
Install **AltStore** (altstore.io) and its helper on your computer, install it on the iPhone, then in the AltStore app on the phone open **My Apps, +** and pick the .ipa (copy it to the phone first, for example with AirDrop or the Files app). AltStore refreshes the app by itself while it is on the same Wi-Fi as your computer. Steps 4 and 5 above apply too.

Method C: Xcode (Mac only, for developers)

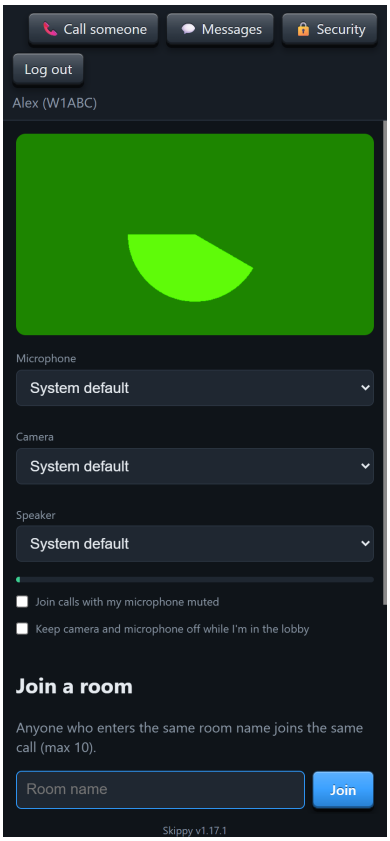
Download the source from github.com/lrizio/Skippy, run **cd android && npm install && npm run build:ios**, open **android/ios/App/App.xcodeproj** in Xcode, choose your team under **Signing & Capabilities**, plug in the phone and press Run.

First start

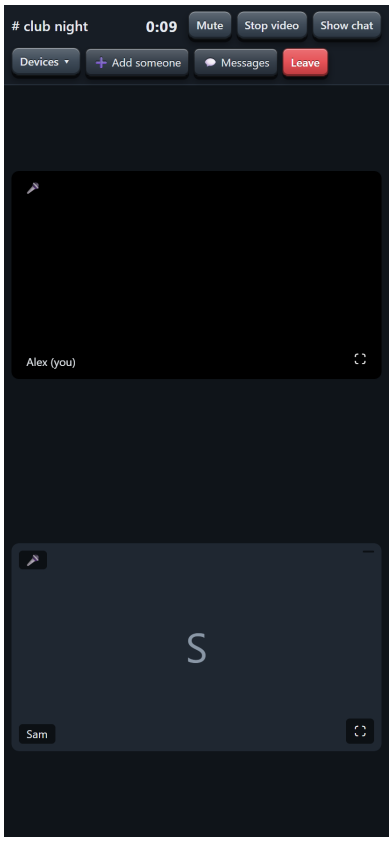
1. Open **Skippy**. On the login screen open **Server** and enter the server address.
2. Create an account or log in; save the **recovery key**.
3. iOS asks for **camera**, **microphone** and, possibly, **local network** access. Allow them all. (Later changes: **Settings, Skippy**.)



Enter the server address under **Server**.



The lobby.



In a call.

Screens above were captured from the Android build; the iPhone app shows the same layout.

Using the iPhone app

To do this	Do this
Join or start a room	Type a room name in the lobby and tap **Join**, or tap a room in the lists.
Call one person	**Call someone** (lobby) or **Add someone** (in a call).
Mute / camera off / flip camera	**Mute**, **Stop video** and **Devices** at the top of the call screen.
Chat and files	**Show chat** opens it over the call; the paperclip sends a file to everyone in the call.
Save a received file	Tap **Save**. Open the **Files** app, **On My iPhone, Skippy**.
Sound output	iOS chooses it: the Control Center audio button switches between speaker, earpiece and Bluetooth.

Keep Skippy open during a call. The screen stays awake in a call, and the audio keeps going if you lock the phone, but people can only call **you** while Skippy is open on the screen.

Troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
"Could not reach the server"	Switch on **Tailscale** (if the address is 100.x), check the address and port, and that the server program is running on its computer.
Mac: app won't open	Right-click, **Open**; or **Privacy & Security, Open Anyway**; or the **xattr** command in Part 1.
Mac: no camera or microphone	**System Settings, Privacy & Security, Camera / Microphone**: switch Skippy on, then quit it completely (Cmd+Q) and reopen.
Mac: window gone	It is hidden, not closed: click the **menu bar icon**, **Open Skippy**.
iPhone: app opens then closes, or says "Untrusted Developer"	Trust your Apple ID in **Settings, General, VPN & Device Management**; turn on **Developer Mode**; if 7 days have passed, sign it again with Sideloadly/AltStore.
iPhone: no video or sound	**Settings, Skippy**: allow Camera and Microphone. Check **Mute** and **Stop video**, the silent switch and the volume.
Forgot my password	Use **Forgot password?** on the login screen with your recovery key.

Reporting a problem

Because the author can't test on Apple hardware, your report is how these apps get fixed. Open an issue at **github.com/lrizio/Skippy/issues** (or send the author a message) and say:

- **Which app** (Mac or iPhone) and the **version** (shown as "Skippy v..." on the login and lobby screens).
- Your **macOS / iOS version** and the Mac model or iPhone model.
- **What you did**, what you expected and what happened (a screenshot helps). For a call problem, say whether the other person was on Windows, Android, Mac or iPhone.
- Please **don't** include passwords, recovery keys or the server's address if it's private.

Also useful: tell the author what *did* work, so it can be marked as verified.

Skippy for Mac and iPhone share their code with the Windows desktop app (v1.18.0); the desktop User Guide covers accounts, rooms and running the server in more detail. Source and releases: github.com/lrizio/Skippy.